

Whitney Kotlewski, PhD

VP of Product | Product Strategy | Portfolio Leadership | AI, Data & Spatial Platforms

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SUMMARY

Product executive with 17 years inventing and scaling B2B platforms across AI, data, spatial analytics, 3D and digital twins, and mission-critical operations, including 5 years in senior leadership (Director/Sr. Director/VP). VP of Product at Slingshot Aerospace reporting to the CTO; leads vision, strategy, and multi-product roadmaps; builds AI-powered planning systems; and scales organizations that deliver impact.

EXPERIENCE

Slingshot Aerospace, El Segundo, CA

Apr 2024 – Present

VP of Product (2025–Present) / Sr. Director of Product (2024–2025) / Head of Product Design & Research (2024)

- Report to the CTO; scaled the product organization from 3 to 19 across product management (Space, Platform, Growth), strategy and design, research, customer experience, and space data (US/UK).
- Own SOIA vision and multi-quarter roadmaps; launched Slingshot Portal (2026), an AI-native Sense, Fuse, Decide, and Act platform for space domain awareness, data fusion, analytics, and mission decision support.
- Growth window: about \$124M capital raised and \$96M+ in U.S. Space Force awards, including a \$27M AI training contract and company-record \$69.2M MENTAT SBIR Phase III.
- Built an AI product-strategy knowledge base from about 250 research documents into scored opportunities (about \$345M) and regenerable roadmaps for faster planning and board decisions.
- Established the company's first unified design systems—Nebula (product) and Rocket Fuel (marketing)—with about 240 design tokens and 1,200+ mission-operations components; overhauled marketing web experience strategy around Portal and core offerings.

Matterport, Sunnyvale, CA

Apr 2021 – Oct 2023

Director, Product Design (Platform & Services)

- Joined through a roughly \$2.9B public listing; led post-IPO product design across eight experiences spanning web, marketplace, eCommerce, cloud, and developer platforms.
- Company revenue grew from about \$111M to \$158M and subscribers from about 503K to 938K by FY2023 while design scaled from 1 to 8 and the broader org from 6 to 20.
- Evolved design systems, accessibility, and research practice; integrated AI/ML into 3D digital-twin experiences; partnered with Marketing on launches and positioning.

Esri, Redlands, CA

Oct 2014 – Apr 2021

Head of UX Innovation (2019–2021) / Co-Founder / Director, Black Girls MAPP (2019–2021) / Design Lead & Sr. UX Architect (2014–2019)

- Led product and UX innovation in a GIS platform business growing from about \$1.1B to \$1.3B+ revenue across mobile navigation, Insights analytics, Site Scan (drone-to-map + AI), and desktop 2D/3D mapping.
- Founded Black Girls MAPP product and design: a 150+ person initiative that delivered 24 maps, 24 layers, 59 apps, and 10 civic products; recognized with the 2021 AAG Diversity & Inclusion Award.

Also: Executive Design Advisor / fractional advisory board, Sonara (2022–2023)—about 80x subscription growth culminating in acquisition by BOLD; Adjunct Professor, Claremont Graduate University, Design for Good Incubator (2024–Present); CX Lead, Pacific Life (2014); UX Lead / Instructor, IUPUI (2010–2013).

EDUCATION

PhD, Information Systems & Technology, Claremont Graduate University, 2017–2024 (AI / data visualization dissertation; patent pending)

MS, Informatics, Indiana University–Purdue University Indianapolis

MS, Human-Computer Interaction and **BA**, Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product Vision and strategy, roadmap prioritization, OKRs, discovery through delivery, go-to-market, defense and civil capture, organization scaling

Innovation AI knowledge-base operations, opportunity sizing, Nebula and Rocket Fuel design systems, zero-to-one platforms

Domain AI/ML, data visualization, spatial/GIS, 3D digital twin, B2B software, mission intelligence

Recognition AAG Diversity & Inclusion Award (2021); GIS for Science Technology Showcase, Vol. 3, Esri Press (2023); PhD dissertation (ProQuest, 2024); patent pending